

Snippets

HCL, IBM to co-develop IoT solutions

HCL and IBM have joined hands to develop Internet of Things (IoT) solutions to help the manufacturing sector. They will focus on specific verticals including industrial and manufacturing and smart facilities to co-develop innovative solutions around connected products and operations such as remote monitoring, smart inventory management, smart building and facilities management.

Infosys, GE to build IoT solutions

Infosys is building new solutions in the IoT space for its clients and has formed a partnership with General Electric (GE) for the same. Industrial Internet refers to the integration of appliances and machinery with sensors and software that are networked.

Orient to increase production

Orient Electric has plans to invest around ₹ 500 million over the next two years to increase its fans and lighting production capacity. Currently, Orient produces over 13 million fans per year at its two factories in Faridabad and Kolkata. The company is also looking to shift its focus from CFL lights to LED lights.

Kerala to strengthen IT, electronics education in schools

According to a minister in Kerala government, IT and electronics education will be strengthened in all schools in the state. Under Learn to Code project,

a joint effort by Kerala Startup Mission and Kerala's IT@School project, 7500 school children will get Raspberry Pi palm computer kits. Likewise, in Electronics@School project, a kit developed by a start-up company will be given to school students.

Government appoints CVCFL as implementing agency for EDF

The government has appointed CANBANK Venture Capital Fund Ltd (CVCFL) as the agency to implement Electronics Development Fund (EDF), which is a Fund of Funds to participate in Daughter Funds, which, in turn, provides risk capital to companies developing new technologies in the areas of electronics, nano-electronics and information technology.

Government announces modification in IEC

The government of India has announced that applicants can seek modifications in Electronic Importer Code (IEC) and e-Electronic Importer Exporter Code (e-IEC) from September 21, 2015 onwards. Applicants, who would like to modify anything in IEC and e-IEC documents, can do it online.

HP to expand printer sales in India

Hewlett-Packard (HP), one of the world's largest computer and peripherals manufacturers, is looking to expand its printer sales in the Indian market. The company has launched a range of printers and scanners, priced between ₹ 25,000 and ₹ 69,500.

Microsoft launches commercial cloud services in India

Microsoft has launched its local data centres in India, which will offer its Azure cloud services, much earlier than its deadline of December this year. This will help the company build more confidence among the government, Indian companies and small and medium businesses in India. The centres are being launched at Pune, Chennai and Mumbai.

Microsoft CEO, Satya Nadella, had announced setting up of the cloud centres almost a year ago in India, pegging the cloud opportunity in the country at nearly US\$ 2 trillion. Industry experts had welcomed the

move, agreeing that local data centres would give Microsoft more leverage to compete in the Indian market, especially in the government and regulated sectors such as banking, finance and state-owned enterprises.

The company has received interest from over 125 customers in banking, financial services and insurance, government departments and organisations, independent software vendors, e-commerce organisations and start-ups.

Fujifilm India aims ₹ 1.2 billion sales from instant camera

Japanese imaging firm Fujifilm is targeting ₹ 1.2 billion sales next fiscal from its Instax range of instant cameras in India and expects India to contribute eight per cent to its global sales in this segment.

Fujifilm was once one of the global leaders in photo films and is trying to make a come-back. The company is targeting the young generation and is exploring online space to boost sales of its instant cameras. Its products are available at almost all leading e-commerce portals.

Asus joins Make in India

Taiwanese multinational electronics company Asus has announced that it will be manufacturing smartphones in the country. For this the company has partnered with global electronic manufacturing services giant Foxconn. All devices will be manufactured in Andhra Pradesh where Foxconn has its plant.

The first smartphone to be manufactured in India will be Zenfone 2 Laser, followed by Zenfone Go. Initially, Foxconn plans to manufacture 150,000 Asus phones per month. This number is expected to gradually grow as demand surges in the Indian market.

According to Peter Chang, regional head - South Asia and country manager - System Business Group, Asus India, India is a great market to invest in because of the Make in India initiative. The focus of the company will be to provide high-class smartphones at affordable prices.

According to Dalip Sharma, MD, Delta India Electronics, the company is in the process of acquiring land in Tamil Nadu for setting up the manufacturing unit. The company will also hire 5000 people for working at this plant over a period of next seven years.

They would approach the government of India's Department of Electronics and IT (DeitY) for approval under Modified Special Incentive Package Scheme, which provides subsidy for investments in capital expenditure, which is 20 per cent for investments in special economic zones (SEZs) and 25 per cent in non-SEZs. It also provides for reimbursement of countervailing duty or excise for capital equipment for the non-SEZ units.

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